

Canto de la Playa

Tour Guide · Saona Island, Dominican Republic

About the Beach

Canto de la Playa is a pristine, undeveloped beach on the far western tip of Saona Island (Isla Saona) in the Dominican Republic. It is known for its soft white (sometimes pink-tinged) sand, crystal-clear turquoise water, and rows of palm trees.

Unlike the busier beaches on Saona that receive large day-trip crowds, Canto de la Playa remains quieter and more natural. There are no hotels, bars or vendors — just sand, sea and palms. It has been ranked among the world's best beaches.

Quick Facts

Location	Western tip of Saona Island, Dominican Republic
Access	By boat only (speedboat from Bayahíbe)
Sand	Fine white / pinkish coral sand
Water	Calm, clear turquoise; reef nearby
Facilities	None – completely natural / virgin beach
Best for	Swimming, snorkelling, quiet nature

Best Time to Visit

The Dominican Republic has a tropical climate. The driest and most popular period is roughly **December to April**. The beach can be visited year-round; rain is more common from May to November.

How to Get There

Canto de la Playa can only be reached by boat. There are no roads or hotels on this part of Saona.

From Bayahíbe / Dominicus

- Most tours leave from the marina in Bayahíbe (near Dominicus).
- Journey by speedboat is about 40–50 minutes.
- Many Saona Island day trips include a stop at Canto de la Playa, often later in the day when other beaches are busier.
- Private boat charters are also available for a quieter visit.

From Punta Cana and other resorts

- Hotel pick-up is usually included in organised tours.
- Transfer to Bayahíbe takes about 1–1.5 hours depending on location, then the boat ride.

What to Do

- Swim in the calm, clear water
- Snorkel near the reef (often shallow and good for beginners)
- Walk along the long stretch of white sand and palms
- Relax and enjoy the quiet, undeveloped setting
- Many tours also stop at Mano Juan village and a natural pool (piscina natural)

What to Bring

- Reef-safe sunscreen, hat and sunglasses
- Swimwear, towel and change of clothes
- Water and snacks (nothing is sold on the beach)
- Insect repellent (there can be flies/horseflies)
- Snorkel gear if not provided by your tour
- Cash for tips or extras on the tour
- Bag for rubbish — leave no trace

Facilities

There are no facilities at Canto de la Playa — no toilets, bars, loungers, umbrellas or shops. It is a completely natural beach. Organised tours usually provide lunch, drinks and equipment on the boat or at other stops.

Useful Tips

1. Choose a tour that specifically includes Canto de la Playa — not all Saona trips go there.
2. Smaller group / VIP tours are quieter and often better timed.
3. Bring insect repellent; the beach can have flies at times.
4. Respect the environment — take all rubbish away with you.
5. The water is usually calm thanks to the protective reef.
6. Book in advance in high season (December–April).

Information compiled for 2026. Always check current tour schedules, prices and sea conditions with local operators before booking.

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